Synthwave / Outrun Sound Packs for the DSI Tempest

A comprehensive guide to every available preset pack, sample library, and free resource

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No preset pack specifically branded as "synthwave," "outrun," or "retrowave" currently exists for the Dave Smith Instruments Tempest. However, the Tempest's Curtis analog filters, classic waveforms, and six-voice polyphonic architecture make it inherently suited to 80s-style production. Several available sound packs are directly useful for synthwave. Below is every Tempest sound resource currently available, ranked by synthwave relevance.

SysEx Preset Packs (load directly onto hardware)

Bitrotten TR-606 & DR-110 Emulation Kit

The single most synthwave-relevant Tempest resource. Created by Leviathant, this free pack recreates Roland TR-606 and Boss DR-110 drum sounds using pure analog synthesis on the Tempest. The sound designer spent a year comparing oscilloscope and spectrum analyzer readings of real vintage hardware against Tempest output. Classic Roland and Boss drum machine sounds are foundational to synthwave production. Free with a suggested $5 donation.

Download: bitrotten.com/tempest

Tim Mantle / Psalm37 — 128 Synth + 160 Drum Sounds

The highest-quality commercial option. Mantle is a professional sound designer who created factory sounds for the DSI Prophet 12, Pro 2, KORG Prologue, and Novation Summit. His Tempest sets total 288 patches covering pads, leads, bass, and comprehensive percussion. Historically priced around £5–10 per set.

Purchase: timmantle.com or search eBay store "psalm37audio"

Deep Mind Dark — 512 Sound Pack

The largest single collection: 256 synth sounds + 256 percussion sounds in one SysEx project file. By Peter Jaczewski. Priced at $17. Requires firmware Main OS 1.5.0.2 or later.

Purchase: Gumroad · Bandcamp

Deep Mind Dark — Mopho Presets to the Tempest

Ports 384 classic DSI Mopho synthesizer sounds into Tempest format, organized as 12 beats × 32 sounds. The patch list explicitly includes a "BladeRunner" patch alongside classic analog bass, lead, pad, and effects sounds — directly relevant to synthwave. Priced at $17. A free 32-sound demo is available.

Purchase: Bandcamp · **Free demo:** PresetPatch.com

Hardwarecore #1 — 64 Synth Patches (FREE)

64 synth patches (16 pads, 16 bass, 16 leads, 16 additional). Originally $10, now completely free. High synthwave relevance given its focus on pad, bass, and lead sounds. Includes WAV previews.

Download: hardwarecore.wordpress.com · Sequential Forum

Sylvain Moreau — DSI Tempest BD1

41 expertly designed kick drum sounds in SysEx format, with detailed programming notes. A snare release is reportedly in development.

Purchase: sylvainmoreau.com

32 Synth Presets

Focuses on using the Tempest as a six-voice polysynth. ~5.8kB SysEx file.

Download: Gumroad

Audio Sample Libraries (WAV)

HelloSamples — Raw Drums DSI Tempest

The most comprehensive option with 4,000+ one-shot samples recorded through high-end preamps, completely unprocessed. Includes 815 Ableton kits, 65 MPC kits, and 65 Maschine kits. Ideal for adding gated reverb, compression, and other synthwave production techniques. Priced from €22 (audio only) to €34 (full bundle).

Purchase: hellosamples.com

LØSTLVLS — Sample Pack // DSI Tempest

Includes synth sounds alongside drums: 576 one-shots at 24-bit/48kHz covering bass drum, snare, percussion, hi-hats, cymbals, bass, lead, pad, and effects — plus 9 sample chains and an Ableton Live Selector Kit. Includes Octatrack-compatible .ot files. Pay-what-you-want pricing.

Purchase: Bandcamp

Polynominal — Dave Smith Tempest Sample Pack

320 samples (24-bit/44kHz mono) — 55 kicks, 51 snares, 58 hi-hats, 19 toms, 10 claps, 9 cowbells, and 92 miscellaneous percussion hits. Budget-friendly at €5 / 13MB.

Purchase: Gumroad · polynominal.com

Boxed Ear — Tempest vs MPC60 (FREE)

90 WAV files of Tempest analog drums resampled through an Akai MPC60 for 12-bit lo-fi character. More suited to lo-fi aesthetics than clean synthwave, but the gritty analog source sounds are versatile.

Download: boxedear.com/free.html

Bullyfinger — Tempest Drums (Splice)

102 samples (32 kicks, 24 snares, 20 claps, 14 hats, 12 808-style, 12 toms). Accessible via Splice subscription credits.

Access: Splice

Free Resources & Sound Design Tutorials

Tempest Recipes by NoisyLittleBugger

The gold standard educational resource — a 16-part drum synthesis tutorial series covering bass drums, snares, hi-hats, cowbells, claps, congas, SID-chip sounds, and more. Each installment includes SysEx patches alongside detailed explanations. 267,595+ visits.

Visit: noisylittlebugger.net/tempest-recipes

Sequential Official Factory Sound Sets

Two free SysEx downloads — the original set (OS 1.0–1.3) and the updated OS 1.4 set. The Tempest also contains 450+ built-in digital samples of classic drum machines.

Download: sequential.com/tempest-factory-sounds

Sequential Forum — Patch Exchange Thread

72+ replies and 216,000+ views — the single best community hub for free Tempest patches. Additional threads include a free online sound randomizer and a midi.link sound exchange platform.

Visit: Patch Exchange · Sound Randomizer · midi.link Exchange · 288 New Sounds

Community Forums

ModWiggler Sound Repository: modwiggler.com
Gearspace Custom Kits Thread: gearspace.com
Retrothusiast (synth demos): retrothusiast.com

Practical Synthwave Roadmap

For drums: Start with the free Bitrotten TR-606/DR-110 emulation kit, then process through external gated reverb for the quintessential synthwave snare (the Tempest lacks onboard reverb — use individual voice outputs routed to external effects).

For synth sounds: Load Tim Mantle's 128 synth patches or the free Hardwarecore #1 set for pads, bass, and leads. The Deep Mind Dark Mopho conversion includes a "BladeRunner" patch and other 80s-relevant sounds.

For learning: Study Tempest Recipes to program detuned saw pads with the Curtis lowpass filter, PWM bass lines, and analog lead sounds from scratch.

For DAW integration: The LØSTLVLS sample pack provides 576 ready-to-use Tempest one-shots including synth sounds, while HelloSamples offers 4,000+ raw drum hits for maximum flexibility.

Total investment ranges from $0 (free resources only) to roughly $50–70 (best paid SysEx packs + a sample library).